

### ASSIGNMENT 3: Reflections and Lessons from Internship

This summer, I worked at Katalyst PR, located in Solana Beach, California. My internship lasted 10 weeks, with 12 hours of work per week. As a Public Relations Intern at Katalyst PR, I support the team in executing creative and strategic campaigns for hospitality, lifestyle, and retail clients. My responsibilities include assisting with media monitoring and clipping press coverage, updating media and influencer lists, drafting pitches and blurbs, and posting client events on local event calendars. I contribute to brainstorming sessions, influencer research, and social media coverage for client events, while also attending client meetings and agency check-ins to stay aligned with ongoing projects. Additionally, I assisted in planning, organizing, and leading social media coverage for an influencer event with Pali Wine Co., which helped me gain knowledge in influencer marketing and the behind-the-scenes aspects of events. This role has allowed me to develop strong writing, communication, and organizational skills while gaining hands-on experience in the fast-paced world of public relations.

I gained hands-on experience in many aspects of public relations that went beyond the classroom. I learned how to clip and log media coverage to track client press, draft pitches that balance creativity with professionalism, and research targeted influencer lists tailored to specific brands. I also developed skills in posting client events on local calendars, supporting social media coverage for influencer hostings, and sitting in on client meetings to observe how relationships are built and maintained. Beyond technical skills, I learned the importance of attention to detail, adaptability in a fast-paced environment, and how collaboration within a team helps bring campaigns to life. My favorite thing I learned in the internship was the event planning behind influencer marketing events. From building an influencer list to managing their social media coverage, it was an amazing experience to expand beyond my influencer knowledge. Additionally, the building of the influencer lists has so much work behind the scenes that it was interesting to see. My favorite part was building relationships with the influencer in a way that makes the business more organic and helps the network. Another new skill I learned was drafting pitches and expanding my writing skills. It was a great experience to build on my

writing skills and learn to write in a professional setting for events being published for the clients.

One of the things that surprised me most during my internship was how much behind-the-scenes organization and detail go into PR work that often looks effortless from the outside. Additionally, communication with clients is so fast-paced. The communication about how the client wants the deliverables delivered in a certain manner. Similarly, I was surprised by how quickly timelines move, press clips, event postings, and influencer outreach often need to be turned around the same day, and how essential it is to stay organized to keep campaigns on track. I also didn't realize how much creativity is involved in even the smallest tasks, like crafting a subject line for a pitch or tailoring event blurbs for different outlets. Especially when you are contacting news outlets and other magazines to help push your press. Getting that connection needs lots of creativity to ensure you catch attention from the press. Finally, I loved how collaborative the environment in PR is. I found it to be very team-oriented, where you help one another build campaigns for clients. The team-focused environment with brainstorming together, sharing feedback, and building on other ideas made me feel like my contributions were making an impact in the client's portfolio.

Through my internship at Katalyst PR, I've developed skills that will directly help me in future roles. Going into my senior year, applying to jobs, I think my strong writing skills and being in such a collaborative environment helped build my confidence to be adaptable. Being very coachable and adaptable was a skill that I found very important in the workforce, which helped me be an asset to the team. I've learned how to write clear, engaging pitches and blurbs, and tracking coverage from client socials helps showcase both my attention to detail and ability to deliver results. As well as tracking deadlines and completing them promptly, it helps with my time management skills. I became confident in researching and building media and influencer lists, which strengthened my ability to identify the right audiences and tailor outreach strategies. I also gained experience supporting live events and social coverage, which taught me to stay organized and adaptable in fast-paced environments. Most importantly, I learned how to collaborate effectively on a team and communicate professionally with clients and media contacts, which I can bring to any role I pursue moving forward.

During my internship, I did notice specific insights and observations related to the EMPAC model. The EMPAC model granted me the opportunity to leverage my knowledge and be an asset to the team. Specifically, I was able to understand the framework of how PR campaigns and branding mesh strategically with being creative. It strengthened my attention to detail, such as creating influencer lists that best match the client's clientele and matching the right pitch to the right managers and clients. Similarly, the matching component of the EMPAC model was the most observed and used throughout my internship. I was tasked with a lot of matching ideas for different clients, as I was not assigned to a set of clients. This meant that any idea could be passed on to any client, meaning matching was crucial in pitching. An example of this was ensuring a restaurant was being matched with foodie journalists rather than fashion journalists or media outlets to make the pitch more specific. Matching an audience to a client's needs in PR is very important as it helps foster a more meaningful relationship and also build a brand. Additionally, the assortment in the EMPAC model was important because our team had to deliver multiple types of deliverables to a client in order to ensure they got the best out of the money being put in. Tailored pitches and deliverables help succeed in a wider range of media press through influencer outreach, event blurbs, calendar listings, and press releases.

Overall, my experience was very positive, and I learned so much from my team and the industry. My 10 weeks at Katalyst were just the beginning of so much knowledge and experience that I am excited to take into my career and future endeavors. My favorite part of being a part of Katalyst was being in a professional environment in the office, and getting exposure to what a 9-5 looks like. I enjoyed getting to know my team and managers and really stepping into my role as a Katalyst Team member.